

the mail into separate folders. To set up multiple identities in Outlook Express, click **File > Identities > Manage Identities** while in the program. Here you can add, modify and delete identities and assign passwords to them. Each user will have a separate view and mail store, as configured by the user when logged on to that identity.

How do I get the best quality scans from my scanner?

The quality of the scanned image depends as much on the scanner as on the scan settings. Usually, you need to be careful with two things: scanning with high quality settings and correcting scan errors (lines and patterns) that are not intended to be on the page. Use appropriate resolutions for scanning—300 to 600 dpi is good for photos. Keep the scan setting at the maximum colour depth that your scanner supports. When you scan content from magazines or newspapers, you will notice a lot of lines on the scanned image. The best way to reduce this pattern is to use the Descreen option in the scanner software. Uncompressed TIFF is the best format to save the scanned images, since it saves the image without any loss in quality. Ghost images (dark areas picked up from the back of the page) can usually be corrected by changing

the brightness and contrast settings. Experiment with these controls to find the best settings for your scanner. Also, place a thick white paper over the document being scanned to reduce this effect.

Always ensure that the glass on the flatbed is absolutely free from dust, fingerprints and other such marks, since these tend to show on the scanned images.

I'd rather work out my finances on paper. The accounting software is too confusing and I don't need to keep as detailed a track as the software does.

You can set up Excel for a basic personal accounting system. All you need to do is to log the relevant income and expenses, use simple formulae for calculating sums and differences and you're done. You can use separate columns for the narration, money transferred, the date and the kind of transaction—that's all you need to track your personal finances. Put in the transaction details under narration, the actual amount of money under money transferred (use positive values for income and negative values for expenses) and you can use the kind of transaction to logically group the sources of income or the kinds of expenditure. These can be logged against the date for each transaction.

That was the hard way. Now here's the easy way: Browse to

microsoft.com/templategallery/ and download a pre-built template for personal finances. All you need to do is change the Dollar notation to Rupees. The Personal Budget workbook is pretty impressive, as is the Personal Finance Statement workbook. There are several other templates available on the Web. The flexibility that Excel offers in terms of sorting, filtering and graphs makes it a very friendly accounting software. Once you get used to it, try some of the advanced functions such as Subtotals, Grouping and Outlining, Consolidation, etc.

Can I send SMS messages from my PC?

Yes, you can send SMS messages from your PC. ICQ has an excellent network that allows you to send SMS messages to most popular mobile services. All you need to do is sign up with ICQ at www.icq.com, download the ICQ client and you're all set.

Login to the client, choose the person you want to send the message to and check the box next to the Send by SMS option. ICQ also lets you send SMS messages from the Web site itself. It also maintains a personal inbox where you can receive messages sent via SMS to your ICQ account.



Send SMS messages from the ICQ Web site

Mobile services such as BPL Mobile allows you to send SMS messages via e-mail, using the format number@service.com for the To address. Thus, if you want to send a message to a BPL Mobile subscriber, just send a plain text e-mail to his mobilenumber@bplmobile.com.



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